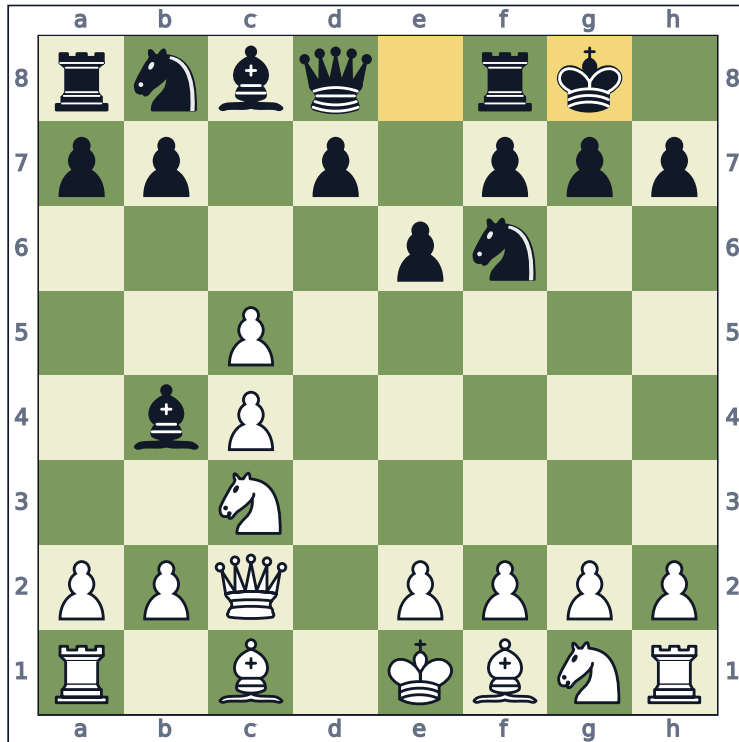


NIMZO-INDIAN DEFENSE

Nimzo-Indian Defense

ECO E39 | 2 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.46 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Sharp and concrete: initiative, development, and king safety outweigh routine positional rules.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E39 covers Nimzo-Indian Defense. Black pins the c3 knight and fights for e4, often exchanging a bishop for structural control or rapid development. The diagram uses the featured line Nimzo-Indian Defense: Classical Variation, Berlin Variation, Pirc Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Qc2 c5 5. dxc5 O-O

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the bishop pair and central space, manage doubled pawns constructively, and decide whether e4 or a queenside advance is realistic.

BLACK'S GOALS

Pressure c4/e4, exploit weak squares, and choose the right moment to surrender or preserve the dark-squared bishop.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black uses ...c5, ...d5, or ...e5; White often seeks e4, d5, or queenside expansion with a3 and b4.

PIECE MAP

The c3 knight, e4 square, and bishop-pair decision are the strategic core. The material imbalance means development and compensation must be calculated, not assumed.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Doubled pawns are not automatically weak: activity, open files, and central control may compensate fully. Do not judge the gambit only by the pawn count; compare king safety, tempi, and open lines.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. White is ahead by about 1 pawn unit. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on c5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of Black's very best defenses to 1.d4, rich enough for a lifetime of study.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named E39 line

This section preserves all 2 names and defining routes assigned to E39 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Classical Variation, Berlin Variation, Macieja System

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Qc2 c5 5. dxc5 O-O 6. a3 Bxc5 7. Nf3 b6

002 Nimzo-Indian Defense: Classical Variation, Berlin Variation, Pirc Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Qc2 c5 5. dxc5 O-O